

Michael Kato

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Skills

Python, C#, C++, JavaScript, SQL, HTML, Unity Engine, Unreal Engine, RenderDoc, Maya, Blender, Photoshop, Perforce, Git, Mercurial, Shaders, VFX, Rigging, Performance Optimization, Automated Testing, Data Visualization, Deep Learning, LLM Integration, Procedural Content

Experience

Meta August 2020 – December 2023

Senior Technical Artist (IC5) – Horizon Worlds (VR)

- Embedded with a dedicated performance engineering team of 4–6, contributing at an engineering level through direct performance fixes, instrumentation, triage, and regression management for a live VR platform targeting 72fps on mobile hardware with 300,000 monthly active users
- Instrumented Unity game code to output performance data across the platform, extending a core telemetry system into new areas and ensuring deep, actionable performance visibility
- Contributed to an automated regression testing pipeline with ~20 recurring test scenarios and a per-commit A/B performance comparison system, handling test authoring, breakage triage, and backend infrastructure maintenance
- Built multi-faceted SQL dashboards tracking performance trends by world, player count, and hitch frequency — a scope of data engineering work more typical of a Data Scientist than a Technical Artist role

Apple June 2019 – August 2020

Technical Artist – Synthetic Data for Apple Vision Pro (Contract)

- Built and maintained fully automated nightly pipelines in Python for procedural scene generation, LOD generation, thumbnail creation, and metadata validation covering thousands of Maya scenes across the project
- Developed comprehensive QA tooling that validated assets, scenes, and metadata against a broad suite of error checks, catching issues before they reached the render farm
- Built tools packager and asset ingestion workflows for outsourcing teams, so that they had access to the same tools as our team without needing access to our Perforce depot

Sledgehammer Games March 2014 – May 2019

Technical Artist – Call of Duty: Advanced Warfare, Black Ops 3, WWII, Cold War

- Led CPU and GPU performance optimization across singleplayer, Zombies, and multiplayer modes, achieving consistent 60fps on all console platforms
- Served as primary contributor, integrator, tester, and user for auto-generated LOD system on Call of Duty: WWII, operating as the sole dedicated TA on that system
- Built and maintained tools across the Maya, Photoshop, Substance, and proprietary pipelines including exporters, mesh modifiers, rigging tools, level editors, and batch scripts
- Became a primary technical troubleshooter for a 300-person studio and multiple support studios, resolving hundreds of blocking production, tooling, and pipeline issues across art, design, and engineering workflows
- Owned the destructible and dynamic prop authoring process across multiple titles, delivering approximately 200 props that integrated models, VFX, audio, physics, collision, and scripting into grounded and fun in-game systems

Education

The Art Institute of Silicon Valley

BA in Game Art & Design

July 2009 – March 2013 | Sunnyvale, CA